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EU AI Act Greece



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AI & Partners defends and extends the digital rights of users at risk around the world. By combining direct technical support, comprehensive policy engagement, global advocacy, grassroots professional services, regulatory interventions, and participating in industry groups such as AI Commons, we fight for fundamental rights in the artificial intelligence age.

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Who Are We

AI That You Can Trust

Why Us?

Stay on the right side of history. At AI & Partners, we believe AI should unlock potential—not cause harm. We’ve seen the fear and fallout when teams lose control of AI, but also the trust and innovation that follow when it’s handled responsibly. That’s why we exist: to help you build AI you can trust and stand behind—for the long run.

80%

of AI systems
are unknown

What Do We Do?

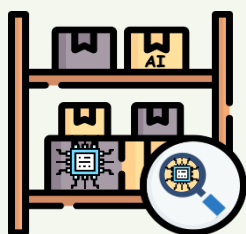
We enable safe AI usage—for your organization and your clients. Unknown AI adoption leads to confusion, risk, and reputational damage. We help you take control with tools to identify, monitor, and govern all AI systems—so you're not reacting to AI, you're leading it.



How Do We Do It?

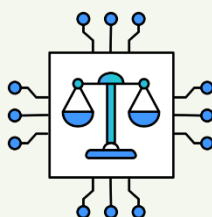
Do you know what AI systems you have? Identify all known and unknown AI systems (algorithms, LLMs, prompts, and models) from all internal and external AI vendors, automated by generating your inventory. Overall, 80% of AI inventory is unknown to our clients.

How do you guarantee ongoing safe AI use? Continuously monitor deployed AI systems for performance drift, anomalies or failures, real-world impacts, and emerging risks (e.g. data poisoning). Any malfunction of an AI system has severe implications for organisations (e.g. inability to assess online misinformation that leads to widespread public mistrust), so monitoring becomes a matter of urgency.



AI Discovery & AI Inventory

Automatically detect all AI systems, including models, algorithms, and prompts, and maintain a live, always-updated register for full visibility and compliance.



Responsible AI

Embed fairness, transparency, and control into every stage of AI use—aligning with the EU AI Act and building ‘Trustworthy-by-Design’.



Model Monitoring

Continuously track your AI models after deployment to detect drift, bias, or failure—so you stay in control and prevent harm before it happens.



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Overview

Greece's AI Strategy builds on its commitment to democratic values and societal well-being to responsibly deploy and govern AI. **This positioning reflects both regulatory alignment and an ambition to unlock inclusive socioeconomic benefits through ethical, trusted AI systems**

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is rapidly transforming societies and economies worldwide, and Greece is navigating its AI governance pathway in alignment with broader EU objectives. Embracing AI's potential while addressing emerging risks, Greece has adopted a values-driven, innovation-friendly, and EU-aligned approach to AI governance. Rather than developing sweeping national legislation, Greece is implementing the European Union's AI Act, while supplementing it with domestic frameworks, sectoral initiatives, and strategic tools to ensure responsible, secure, and transparent AI deployment. **This approach ensures legal certainty and interoperability for Greek companies operating in the single market, while allowing room for local adaptations.**

At the core of Greece's AI governance strategy is its alignment with the EU AI Act, which entered into force on August 1, 2024, with provisions on prohibited AI practices enforceable since February 2, 2025. This is operationalized through national instruments such as Law 4961/2022, which mandates algorithmic impact assessments for public entities deploying AI, enhances transparency obligations, and introduces mechanisms for public registries of AI systems and referred to the legal **legal framework supports the EU AI Act's Article 29 on impact assessments and Article 52 on transparency, signaling early national alignment..** These measures are reinforced by the obligation to perform data protection and algorithmic impact assessments, particularly for AI systems that impact citizens' rights. These tools are complemented by targeted sectoral efforts—ranging from specialized AI Testing and Experimentation Facilities (TEFs) to the AI Factory Pharos and the DAEDALUS supercomputer, which foster ethical data usage and secure AI development.

It is supported by bodies such as the High-Level Advisory Committee on AI, the Coordinating Committee for AI, and the AI Observatory. Organisation, such as the National Commission for Bioethics and Technoethics, and non-governmental organisations, such as the National Institute of Artificial Intelligence, Personal Data and Digital Governance (Rythmis), play key roles in embedding governance principles within public policy and industrial innovation, especially in healthcare. Key authorities responsible for enforcing AI-related safeguards also include the Hellenic Data Protection Authority and the Greek Ombudsman. Greece's AI governance is also shaped by its commitment to international standards. AI is a key pillar of Greece's Digital Transformation Bible, setting out principles for ethical AI aligned with democracy, sustainability, and trust. Greece's national AI strategy aligns with UNESCO and OECD AI principles.

Through its active participation in EU initiatives and standardisation platforms, Greece advances a coordinated vision rooted in democratic values, human rights, and technological sovereignty.

As outlined in its national AI strategy, currently being finalized, Greece envisions AI as a critical enabler of digital transformation, sustainable development, and global competitiveness. Strategic priorities include building compute capacity through initiatives like the AI Factory Pharos under EuroHPC, promoting SME participation through supportive ecosystems, and expanding AI education through training programs and skill development initiatives. Other flagship projects include the establishment of a National AI Research Institute to coordinate innovation efforts, AI Regulatory Sandboxes for testing applications in controlled environments, and a National AI Data Hub to centralize datasets for research and development. Greece is also advancing a Greek AI Data Space, designed to capture and structure datasets relevant to the Greek language and cultural heritage. **While these efforts set a solid foundation, successful implementation will depend on reducing adoption barriers, especially for SMEs and underserved regions.** Tools such as the ethical principles outlined in the Digital Transformation Bible, the work of the National Commission for Bioethics and Technoethics, and foresight studies by national research institutions foster ethical and human-centric AI design from the outset. The strategy also emphasizes the integration of AI in public administration. Initiatives include AI-powered healthcare for diagnostics and personalized medicine, cybersecurity and defense applications, smart city solutions for urban planning and infrastructure, and AI tools for managing environmental challenges and preserving cultural heritage. These practical uses aim to make government services more efficient, secure, and citizen-focused.

Through a combination of EU harmonization, national infrastructure development, and global engagement, Greece is advancing a governance model that balances technological leadership with democratic accountability.





Specific AI Governance or Law

Greece has no standalone AI law but aligns with the EU AI Act, partially applicable since February 2025, with full implementation by August 2026. Law 4961/2022 supports national adoption through algorithmic impact assessments, transparency rules, and public registries. Key oversight bodies include the Data Protection Authority, Ombudsman, and Human Rights Commission.

Specific AI Governance in Greece

Greece has not enacted standalone national legislation exclusively for AI but has taken significant steps to domestically align with the EU AI Act, which entered into force on August 1, 2024. Provisions on prohibited AI practices under the Act have been enforceable in Greece since February 2, 2025. Full implementation across high-risk and general-purpose AI systems is anticipated by August 2026. To support national adoption, Greece enacted L.4961/2022, a law addressing emerging technologies, including AI. It mandates algorithmic impact assessments for public entities deploying AI, enhances transparency obligations, and introduces mechanisms for public registries of AI systems. These measures are reinforced by the obligation to perform data protection and algorithmic impact assessments, particularly for AI systems that impact citizens' rights. Greece has also identified key authorities responsible for enforcing AI-related safeguards, namely the Hellenic Data Protection Authority, the Greek Ombudsman, the Hellenic Authority for Communication Security and Privacy, and the National Commission for Human Rights. By establishing and publishing the list in question, Greece meets the first national obligation to implement the AI Act at the domestic level. The Authorities in question will be granted additional powers, such as access to any documentation created or maintained by an organisation for the purpose of complying with the AI Regulation, effective as of 2 August 2026.

AI Ethics Guidelines and Sectoral Governance Tools

While Greece lacks a unified national ethics framework for AI, several strategic documents and institutions play guiding roles. AI is a key pillar of Greece's Digital Transformation Bible, which sets out principles for ethical AI aligned with democracy, sustainability, and trust. Greece's national AI strategy, currently being finalized, focuses on conditions for AI development, ethical principles, data governance, and national pilot applications. Established in 2021, the National Commission for Bioethics and Technoethics has examined AI's ethical implications, particularly in healthcare. Greece also introduced the National Institute of Artificial Intelligence, Personal Data and Digital Governance Law (Rythmis), a non-governmental organisation ("NGO"), in 2022, which issued initial guidelines for regulating AI systems. National research institutions, including the NCSR 'Demokritos', are engaged in foresight studies and scenario planning around generative AI (Gen AI), supporting ethical and sustainable AI development. The 2023 foresight study outlined four potential futures for Gen AI in Greece, influencing strategic decision-making. To translate these strategic blueprints and turn them into productive results, Greece can assist itself by implementing ethical AI practices into real-world field deployments—first and foremost through cross-sector training, public tender ethical review processes, and more direct guidance for industry stakeholders.

Proposed AI Regulatory Authority and Future Outlook

The Hellenic Ministry of Digital Governance leads Greece's AI policy coordination and implementation of the EU AI Act. It oversees initiatives such as the AI Factory Pharos, established under the EuroHPC AI Factories initiative, which supports innovation in health, sustainability, and culture through AI-optimized infrastructure. Greece has created dedicated bodies to monitor and implement its AI strategy, including the Co-ordinating Committee for AI, the Observatory Committee, and the AI Observatory. These bodies track implementation, define key performance indicators, and ensure the responsible deployment of AI in both public and private sectors. Looking forward, Greece's AI governance trajectory will be shaped by its integration into the broader EU AI framework, domestic legislative evolution, and sectoral priorities. National discussions continue on expanding protections around workplace AI use and data ethics, while industry and research sectors anticipate greater clarity on AI liability, copyright, and generative model governance. Greece's commitment to democratic values, public transparency, and European coordination positions it as an emerging AI policy laboratory in the EU context. To succeed in the long term, Greece will need to invest in regulatory capacity building, clarify institutional roles for oversight and enforcement, and involve industry and civil society in the development of pragmatic AI governance arrangements.



Discussion: Greece's National AI Strategy

'Greece's AI governance approach is grounded in a values-based, human-centric framework that emphasizes responsible, secure, and public good-oriented development of AI. Anchored in the principles of democratic values and fundamental rights, the strategy promotes proportionate regulation and international cooperation. Rather than relying solely on prescriptive legislation, Greece fosters AI through structured ecosystems, research excellence, and cross-sector collaboration—supported by initiatives like specialized AI Testing and Experimentation Facilities (TEFs).'

Transform. Sustainable AI democratisation

Empower. Excellence and democratisation of AI knowledge & infrastructure

Enable. Democratic ethos in AI-by-Design

Innovate. Implementing AI democratisation

Analysis

Greece's AI strategy reflects a comprehensive commitment to embedding AI within a framework of ethical, legal, and societal considerations. The strategy centers on placing AI at the service of people, society, and the environment, underpinned by democratic principles to create a more inclusive and sustainable future. It aligns with global principles by emphasizing the democratization of AI knowledge, infrastructure, design, development, implementation, and evaluation to maximize benefits for all. While the European Union's AI Act advances binding regulations, Greece complements this with a governance approach that integrates sector-specific innovation with principled oversight, particularly through moral ideals and democratic fundamental rights incorporated into AI-by-Design.

A distinguishing feature of Greece's approach is its emphasis on adopting an integrated, value-network perspective, considering the entire AI and Democracy ecosystem and enhancing shared value co-creation among all entities. Regulatory efforts aim to ensure both innovation and accountability, focusing on minimizing risks and ensuring socio-cultural compatibility through the design, experimentation, development, deployment, and evaluation of AI-driven innovations with moral and cross-sectoral impact. Greece's AI governance also supports adaptive implementation mechanisms. Specialized AI Testing and Experimentation Facilities (TEFs) encourage experimental use, iterative learning, and feedback-informed policymaking. These platforms promote evidence-based adjustments to governance frameworks in response to emerging challenges. Another hallmark of Greece's strategy is its systemic focus on embedding AI across sectors through specialized infrastructure and addressing AI talent needs across various sectors through training programs and skill development initiatives. Distributed responsibility is promoted via shared participation by government, industry, academia, and civil society, exemplified by fostering value-network collaboration.

Greece further prioritizes capacity-building through initiatives like establishing training programs and skill development to address AI talent needs. The strategy places a strong emphasis on inclusion to ensure equitable access to AI benefits. Lastly, Greece champions dynamic and sustainable governance. Measures supporting ethical standards and regulatory flexibility reflect a forward-looking vision that addresses the dual imperatives of technological leadership and societal well-being. This allows Greece to remain competitive while reinforcing public trust and democratic accountability in the age of AI. To realize in depth this vision of inclusiveness, Greece will need to enable delivery channels—through better cross-sector cooperation, integration of ethical review into project delivery cycles, and the speeding up of skill building in technical and non-technical careers.





Greece's Approach to AI Regulation and Governance

Greece's AI governance aligns with the EU AI Act, effective from August 2024, with prohibited practices enforceable since February 2025. Law 4961/2022 mandates algorithmic impact assessments, transparency, and AI registries. Greece's forthcoming AI strategy and "Digital Transformation Bible" promote trustworthy AI rooted in human rights, democracy, and sustainability.

1. Regulatory and Strategic Frameworks

Greece's AI governance is firmly embedded within the EU regulatory framework. The EU AI Act, which entered into force on August 1, 2024, forms the cornerstone of AI regulation, with its provisions on prohibited practices enforceable as of February 2, 2025. Greece has aligned its domestic laws accordingly and is finalising its national AI strategy to complement these obligations. Nationally, Greece enacted Law 4961/2022 on emerging technologies, which includes specific provisions on AI governance. This law introduces requirements for algorithmic impact assessments, transparency obligations, and public registries for AI systems—particularly within the public sector. These measures aim to prepare Greece's institutional landscape for full compliance with the EU AI Act by August 2026. AI is further recognised as a strategic pillar in Greece's "Digital Transformation Bible," the government's flagship policy blueprint guiding digital development. The national AI strategy, under the Ministry of Digital Governance, is designed to promote trustworthy AI aligned with democratic values, human rights, and sustainability.



2. Institutional Support and Strategic Missions

AI governance in Greece is overseen by a constellation of specialised entities. The Hellenic Ministry of Digital Governance leads policy coordination, supported by bodies such as the High-Level Advisory Committee on AI, the Coordinating Committee for AI, and the AI Observatory. These institutions are responsible for implementing national AI policy, tracking key performance indicators, and coordinating with EU bodies. Additionally, the Ministry of Digital Governance has identified the main institutions responsible for enforcing or supervising compliance with EU obligations on the protection of the fundamental rights of citizens concerning the use of AI in Greece, namely the Hellenic Data Protection Authority, the Greek Ombudsman, the Authority for Communication Security and Privacy, and the National Commission for Human Rights. Greece's National Commission for Bioethics and Technoethics plays a critical role in evaluating the societal implications of AI, issuing opinions on ethical applications—particularly in sectors like healthcare. Additionally, the Hellenic Data Protection Authority and National Transparency Authority are mandated to ensure that AI systems adhere to legal and ethical norms.





3. Standards Development and Global Engagement

Greece actively contributes to European and international AI governance discussions through its participation in EU initiatives, the OECD, and standardisation platforms. The Greek government is integrating ethical frameworks into its national AI strategy, drawing from EU AI Act guidelines and UNESCO and OECD AI principles. National research institutions such as the NCSR ‘Demokritos’ and Athena Research Centre contribute to policy development and foresight research. Greece has also played a pioneering role in exploring generative AI futures, with scenario-based planning to anticipate societal and regulatory challenges.

4. Sectoral and Extended Regulatory Approaches

While Greece has not passed AI-specific sectoral legislation, it has embedded AI considerations across several legal domains. For example, AI deployment in public services must undergo algorithmic impact assessments to evaluate rights-based risks. In the workplace, companies using AI for hiring, evaluation, or profiling must ensure transparency and non-discrimination under Law 4961/2022. Greece has also begun regulating emerging applications like autonomous vehicles and AI in health, education, and customer service. Future policy developments may extend into areas such as employee data protection and intellectual property as AI adoption intensifies.

5. Fostering Innovation and Indigenous Development

Greece is positioning itself as a testbed for AI innovation, aiming to become a “world laboratory” for sustainable and inclusive AI. Investment is channelled through the National AI Strategy and supported by mechanisms like the Investment Law State Aid Scheme and the Patent Box. The AI Factory “Pharos,” established, which has been among the first seven Artificial Intelligence Factories established in Europe, together with Spain, Italy, Finland, Luxembourg, Sweden, and Germany, under the EuroHPC initiative, is a flagship project driving AI infrastructure and services for key sectors like health, sustainability, and language technology. The DAEDALUS supercomputer underpins this effort, offering compute power and research support to SMEs, startups, and academic institutions.



6. AI in Public Sector Transformation

AI is integral to Greece’s digital governance transformation. Law 4961/2022 enables public bodies to use AI systems in decision-making processes, provided algorithmic assessments and transparency safeguards are met. Public authorities must register AI deployments and ensure explainability to affected individuals. The National Authority for Transparency (ΕΑΔ) is tasked with evaluating public complaints regarding AI system transparency, supporting accountability and democratic oversight. Use cases span domains such as public health, and urban planning.

7. AI Skills, Education and Inclusion

Greece’s AI policy emphasizes human capital development as a foundation for sustainable AI integration. National strategies support AI literacy, interdisciplinary education, and training programs targeting civil servants, researchers, and the private sector. Upskilling programs, academic partnerships, and AI-related curricula are being expanded to support a future-ready workforce. Special focus is given to inclusivity and gender equality in AI careers, in alignment with broader EU social and digital inclusion goals. As Greece advances on these seven strategic pillars, success will depend on how well it facilitates implementation at all levels—through investment in local capacity, cross-sector partnerships, applied AI skills training programs, and institutional clarity to drive relentless and inclusive adoption.



Greece's Approach to Fostering AI Innovation

Greece's AI Strategy builds on its commitment to democratic values and societal well-being to responsibly deploy and govern AI. The strategy emphasizes a human-centric approach, the democratization of AI, and sustainable innovation, with a firm commitment to European collaboration and global standards.

Unlocking Economic Value through Strategic AI Deployment

Greece is harnessing AI to enhance productivity and innovation across sectors by placing AI at the service of people, society, and the environment. While specific initiatives like an "AI Innovation Competition" are not detailed, Greece focuses on the democratization of AI's design, development, and implementation to maximize benefits for all, ensuring national impact through socially beneficial and scalable solutions.

Driving Innovation via Research Clusters and Application Hubs

Greece is driving innovation by adopting an integrated, value-network perspective that considers the entire AI and Democracy ecosystem. This involves enhancing shared value co-creation among all entities and implementing AI Democratization through the design, experimentation, development, deployment, and evaluation of AI-driven innovations. The establishment of specialized AI Testing and Experimentation Facilities (TEFs) serves as a key mechanism to co-create, evaluate, and mature AI innovations, minimizing risks and ensuring socio-cultural compatibility.

Enabling Trusted and Responsible Data Use

Greece's strategy emphasizes enabling trusted and responsible data use by incorporating Democratic Ethos into AI-by-Design, prioritizing moral ideals and democratic fundamental rights in AI technology and systems. This implicitly supports secure, ethical access to high-quality data, aligned with European data protection principles. The focus on "democratizing AI knowledge and infrastructure" suggests a foundational approach to data accessibility.

Scaling AI in Public Administration

Greece aims to scale AI across various sectors, including public administration, by implementing AI Democratization through the design, experimentation, development, deployment, and evaluation of AI-driven innovations with moral and cross-sectorial impact. The establishment of specialized AI Testing and Experimentation Facilities (TEFs) can support the development and adoption of AI applications in public services by allowing for co-creation, evaluation, and maturation of innovations in a controlled environment.





Advancing Compute and Research Infrastructure

Greece recognizes the importance of democratizing AI knowledge and infrastructure. While specific large-scale supercomputing centers are not detailed in the provided content, the focus on "democratizing ... infrastructure" implies a commitment to advancing the underlying compute and research capabilities necessary for AI development and deployment. The establishment of specialized AI Testing and Experimentation Facilities (TEFs) also contributes to the research infrastructure by providing environments for AI innovation.

Empowering SMEs and Startups

Greece's strategy for democratizing AI inherently includes empowering smaller entities and startups by democratizing AI knowledge and infrastructure, as well as its design, development, and implementation. The overall goal of maximizing benefits for "all" implies efforts to lower adoption barriers and foster broad participation in the AI ecosystem.

Developing a Future-Ready Workforce

Greece places a strong emphasis on developing a future-ready workforce by addressing AI talent needs across various sectors. This is achieved through dedicated training programs and skill development initiatives. The strategy aims to democratize AI knowledge and ensure a broad base of individuals are equipped to participate in the AI landscape.

Aligning AI with Sustainability Goals

Greece aligns AI with sustainability goals by emphasizing the placement of AI "at the service of people, society, and the environment." The strategy aims to infuse AI with democratic principles to create a more inclusive and sustainable future, implying the leveraging of AI for environmental protection and broader societal well-being.



Building Public Trust and Ethical AI

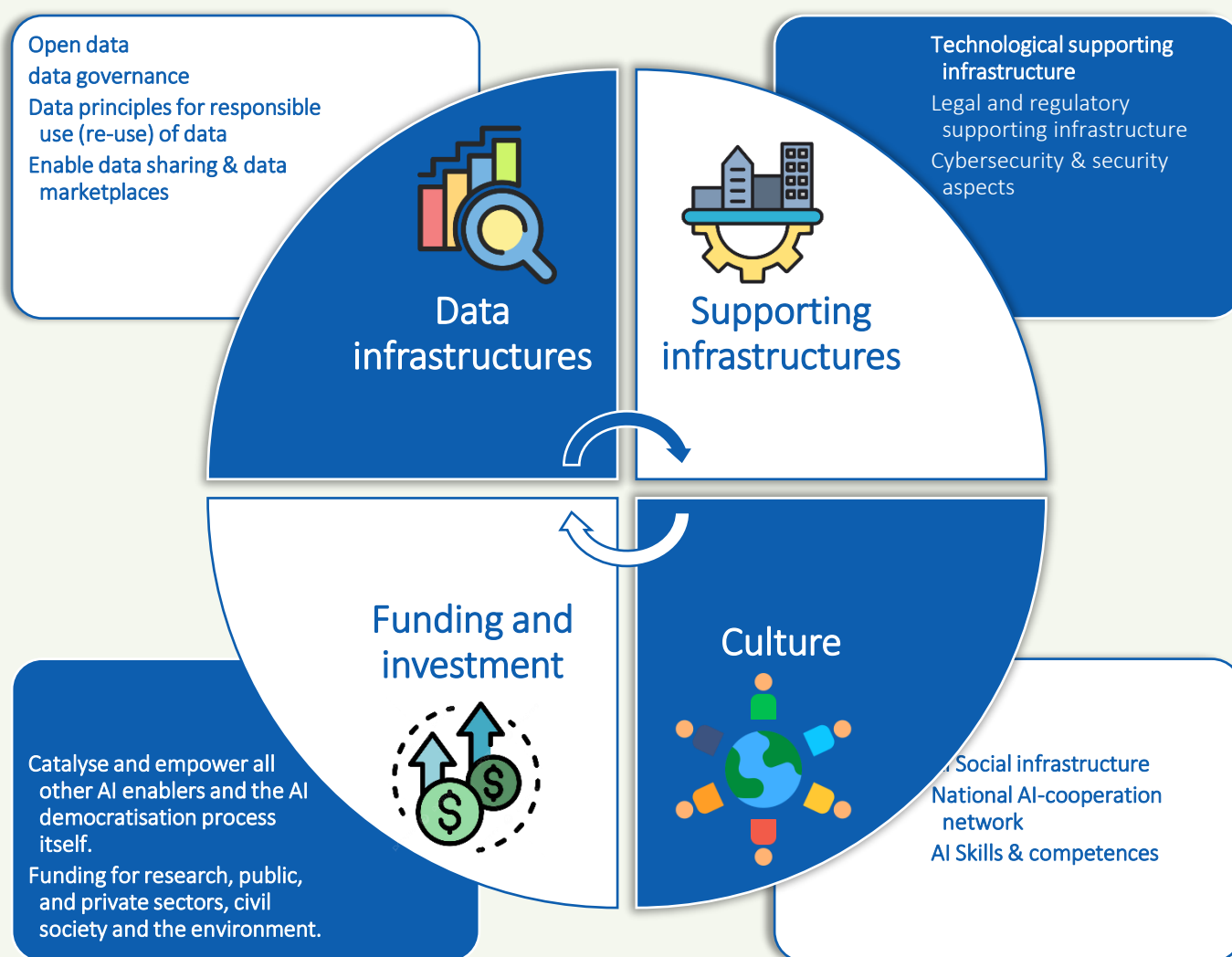
Greece is committed to building public trust and ensuring ethical AI by incorporating "Democratic Ethos into AI-by-Design," prioritizing moral ideals and democratic fundamental rights in AI technology and systems. The strategy emphasizes an integrated, value-network perspective for the entire AI and Democracy ecosystem, enhancing shared value co-creation among all entities, which naturally includes public participation and ethical considerations in design and deployment. The use of specialized AI Testing and Experimentation Facilities (TEFs) also serves to minimize risks and ensure socio-cultural compatibility, contributing to trusted AI.

Shaping Global AI Governance and Standards

Greece is a proactive player in shaping AI governance by infusing AI development with democratic principles and aligning with European and global standards through its "democratizing AI" approach. The strategy implicitly supports harmonized EU-level AI regulations and contributes to a human-centric "AI made in Europe" model based on democratic values and fundamental rights. The emphasis on a "value-network perspective" and "cross-sectorial impact" suggests an active role in broader governance discussions. To unlock the full economic and societal value of AI, Greece must now prioritize implementation levers—i.e., facilitating SME adoption through access to compute resources and mentoring, accelerating workforce upskilling through public-private partnerships, and extending the scope of TEFs from experimentation to deployment.



Figure 1: AI Enablers for Greece's National AI Strategy





Digital Decade 2025: Country Report

Greece has maintained its original national goal of achieving 32% enterprise adoption of AI by 2030, which remains below the EU-wide target of 75%. However, the country is progressing in line with its projected national path. The updated AI roadmap includes significant new efforts to promote AI development.

In response to the 2024 recommendation on digitalising businesses, Greece has begun improving the foundational conditions to support widespread adoption of advanced digital technologies—such as AI, cloud computing, and data analytics—as a means of boosting competitiveness across all sectors. New policy initiatives were introduced in 2024 to align with these goals.

A key milestone came in November 2024, when a high-level committee released a blueprint outlining Greece’s vision for AI transformation. This document will guide the formation of a new national AI strategy. It positions Greece to emerge as a competitive player in AI, while emphasizing the importance of ethics and societal impact. The blueprint includes a dedicated section on how AI can drive innovation and strengthen the country’s business ecosystem. A major upcoming initiative is the launch of one of Europe’s first AI Factories in Greece, which will be central to its AI strategy. Known as the ‘Pharos’ project, this center will unite academia, research institutions, government bodies, and businesses to develop cutting-edge AI-based services. With a total investment of €30 million—equally funded by the EuroHPC Joint Undertaking and national sources—Pharos has been inaugurated on April 15, 2025 and is planned to run for three years.

In early 2024, Greece also released a strategic foresight study on generative AI (GenAI), accompanied by a series of outreach events, including public discussions and informational videos. These efforts aim to raise awareness among citizens and businesses about the possibilities and implications of AI adoption. According to the 2025 Eurobarometer, 82% of Greek respondents believe that public authorities should play a leading role in guiding the development of AI and digital technologies to ensure they uphold societal values and rights—closely aligned with the EU average of 83%. Additionally, the Ministry of Digital Governance has partnered with the CISERO project, which launched in September 2024 in alignment with the Important Project of Common European Interest on Cloud Infrastructure and Services (IPCEI-CIS). CISERO supports the effective use and rollout of technologies developed through IPCEI-CIS, fostering cooperation between EU countries, businesses, research institutions, and public entities to ensure cloud and edge investments contribute meaningfully to Europe’s digital advancement. To complement these EU and national efforts, Greece will need to step up local implementation mechanisms—by empowering SMEs with hands-on AI experience, making regional innovation hubs accessible, and integrating outreach with actionable training and adoption enablement.





Additionally:

- the primary requirement for boosting productivity remains the strengthening of capital investment, particularly addressing Greece's investment gap compared to the EU, which still stands at around 32%.
- Official European data records the strategic use of AI by 6% of Greek SMEs — a figure that is approaching the European average (8%) but still far from the EU goal of 75% business adoption by 2030.
- 1 in 3 SMEs is already engaging in some form of interaction with AI tools, even if at a non-strategic or early stage

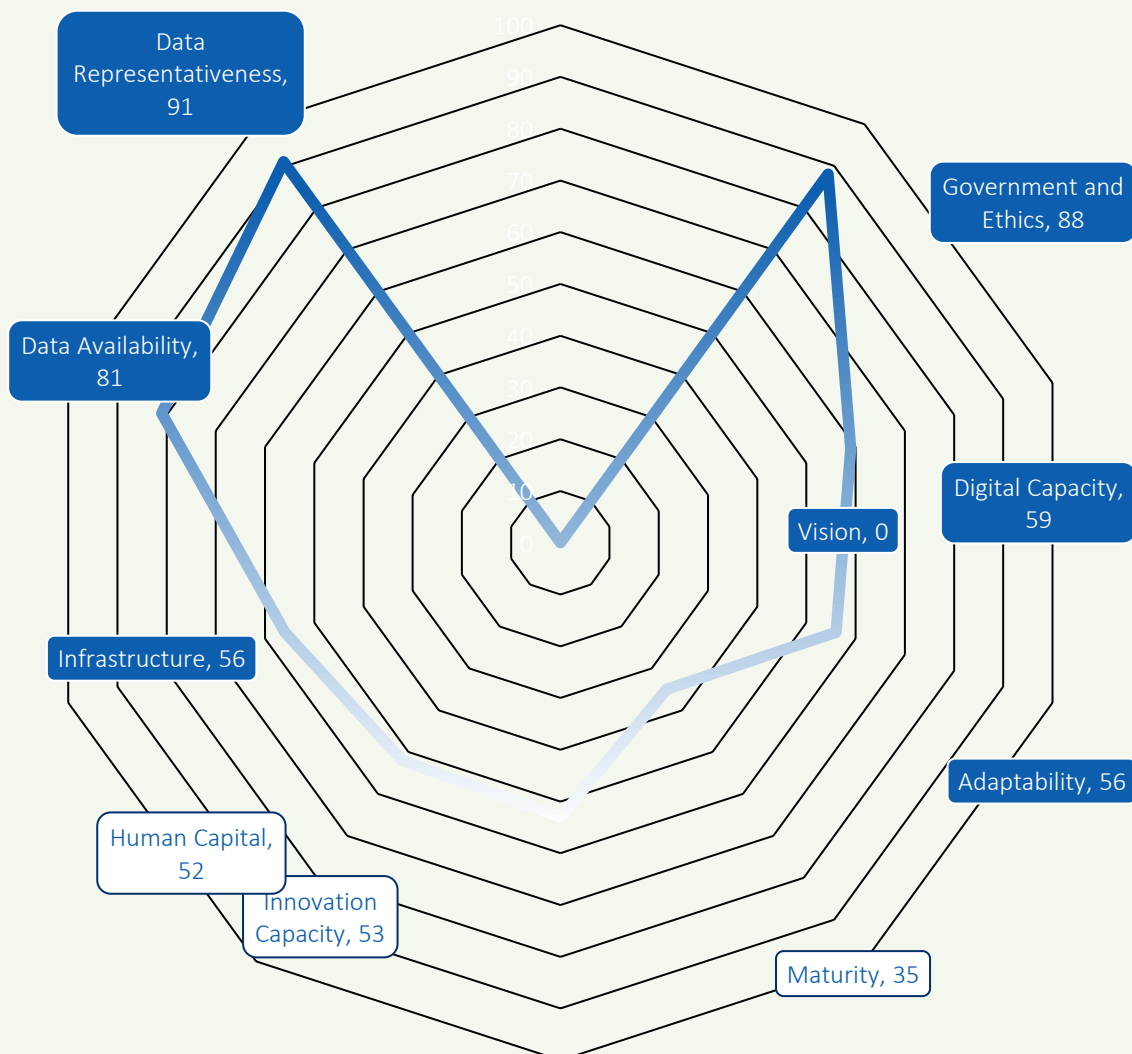




Government AI Readiness by Oxford Insights

Western Europe ranks as the highest-performing region in this year's Government AI Readiness Index, with five countries in the global top 10. France leads the regional ranking with a score of 79.36, narrowly ahead of the United Kingdom (78.88), followed closely by the Netherlands (77.23), Germany (76.90), and Finland (76.48). With an average regional score of 69.56, Western Europe outperforms the global average (47.59) across all three pillars of Government, Technology, and Data & Infrastructure. The region's standout strength is the Data & Infrastructure pillar, where it averages 81.91, more than 21 points above the global benchmark (59.62), reflecting its advanced digital infrastructure and high-quality data environment. Although a few microstates such as San Marino, Liechtenstein, and Andorra fall slightly below the global average in the Government pillar, Western Europe's dominance at the top of the index underscores its continued leadership in AI readiness.

2024 Scores by Dimension





Government

Greece demonstrates a strong institutional commitment to advancing Artificial Intelligence as a tool for public value and economic competitiveness. The country's national strategy for AI embeds responsible AI within national policy, backed by public investment and sector-specific initiatives. Greece adopts a comprehensive approach, integrating national and EU-level efforts while strongly supporting human-centric AI through ethical frameworks and multi-stakeholder engagement. Its focus on infusing democratic principles into AI development reinforces transparency, inclusion, and public trust in AI governance.

Technology Sector

Greece showcases solid foundations in digital innovation and technical capacity, fostering a dynamic AI ecosystem. Strong university-industry linkages, vibrant research initiatives, and innovation efforts stimulate a thriving environment. The country is focused on democratizing AI knowledge and infrastructure, promoting broad participation in the AI landscape. Greece is also making strategic investments in cutting-edge AI capabilities and the establishment of specialized AI Testing and Experimentation Facilities (TEFs), positioning it for steady progress and leadership in advanced AI applications. To maintain this momentum, Greece needs readiness to turn into actual-world adoption: enabling AI deployment in businesses and municipalities; developing interdisciplinary AI talent; and bridging TEF-led innovation with commercial and societal use cases.



Data & infrastructure Sector

Greece is highly prepared in the Data & Infrastructure pillar, underpinned by a strategic focus on secure, ethical data use and investment in advanced digital infrastructure. The nation emphasizes the importance of democratizing AI infrastructure and developing an integrated, value-network perspective that considers the entire AI and Democracy ecosystem. The commitment to scalable compute capacity and secure data exchange creates a fertile ground for sustainable and socially beneficial AI innovation, ensuring that moral ideals and democratic fundamental rights are incorporated into AI-by-Design. To better leverage this infrastructure, Greece must focus on ensuring fair access—allowing SMEs, startups, and public administrations to use compute resources and good data for innovation, testing, and creation of public value.

Greece's AI Strategy builds on its commitment to democratic values and societal well-being to responsibly deploy and govern AI. The strategy emphasizes a human-centric approach, the democratization of AI, and sustainable innovation, with a firm commitment to European collaboration and global standards. Greece features in the Western European regional ranking in this year's Government AI Readiness Index.





AI in Private Sector

While Greece's national AI agenda has made commendable progress in regulation, education, and infrastructure, the private sector remains the missing link in unlocking AI's full economic and societal potential. Adoption across Greek enterprises—especially SMEs—remains fragmented, often limited to isolated pilot projects, vendor-driven automation, or cloud-based productivity tools that do not fully leverage AI's transformative capabilities.

On the basis of the Digital Economy and Society Index (DESI) and recent data from Workable and LinkedIn (2024):

- Less than 13.5% of Greek SMEs report active AI adoption, compared with an EU average of 24%.
- The use of AI postings in Greece rose by 76% between Q1 2023 and Q1 2024, but 70% of employers report not being able to find AI-aware professionals to hire.
- Less than 9% of Greek companies now allocate for AI-related R&D or in-company upskilling schemes.

Mini Case Study – AI in Greek Retail Logistics (2024):

One mid-sized Thessaloniki retail chain piloted an AI-driven inventory forecast tool developed in partnership with a local university lab. Despite achieving a 12% reduction in stock-outs and 6% increase in forecast accuracy, the solution was not deployed because there was not enough in-house technical competency and external AI integration support. This is a bigger trend: AI pilot projects without transformation readiness do not leave lasting impacts.

This deficit is not a reflection of lack of interest—but of structural impediments:

- Too limited access to credible implementation partners,
- Too low exposure to success stories of applied AI,
- Too low financial incentives for experimentation, and
- Too few AI-literate middle managers who can drive change from within.

To overcome these, Greece needs a national business-confronting AI transformation strategy, including:

- A public-private "AI Sandbox for SMEs", enabling test environments with reduced compliance risk.
- Sectoral "AI Readiness Index", to benchmark Greek sectors against their EU counterparts to determine priorities of intervention.
- Nurturing networks that pair local startups, researchers, and AI suppliers with traditional companies.





AI & ESG Synergies

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is revolutionizing business and governance—it is becoming a key enabler of Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) objectives as well. For Greece, a country blessed with natural capital and rising climate adaptation needs, the nexus of AI and ESG presents a strategic opportunity.

AI can also be applied to address short-term environmental challenges in Greece, such as sea pollution, wildfire prediction, energy grid management, and irrigation water distribution. For example, AI-powered platforms are being piloted by Greek agritech firms to maximize water consumption for irrigation and pesticides, boosting crop yields while reducing environmental impact. Similarly, Greek electricity grid operator IPTO has explored AI to better predict energy demand and supply renewables into the grid.

Where green technology and digital change meet, Greece has begun combining AI with sustainability-focused innovation programs, including:

- Smart island projects using AI to balance renewable energy supply and storage.
- Horizon Europe-backed Aegean marine monitoring systems based on artificial intelligence.
- Artificial intelligence-supported air quality forecasting systems for cities like Thessaloniki and Athens.



Although these promising pilots show promise, adoption remains patchy. Only 14% of Greek companies employing AI report applying it on sustainability uses, compared to the EU average of 21% (Eurostat 2025). This gap also provides an opportunity for Greece to act as a regional center for AI-facilitated ESG solutions, particularly in sectors where Greece has natural assets, like tourism, shipping, agriculture, and clean energy.

To enhance influence, Greece could:

- Incentivise ESG-conform AI start-ups through Green AI innovation grants.
- Embed AI-ESG modules within country R&D funding competitions.
- Promote public-private cooperation for sustainable AI uses.
- Implement standards for ethical, explainable uses of AI in environmental data.

By aligning AI policy with the European Green Deal and the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), Greece can leverage AI not just for economic competitiveness but as a catalyst for planetary and social resilience.



Conclusion

Greece's Artificial Intelligence ecosystem is entering a critical juncture—poised to translate substantial public investment, research leadership, and regulatory momentum into broad-based, sustainable impact. With a cohesive national vision embedded in its evolving national AI strategy and reinforced through its commitment to EU objectives, Greece has laid a strong foundation for AI innovation that reflects its values of democratic accountability, technological sovereignty, and human-centricity. Initiatives like specialized AI Testing and Experimentation Facilities (TEFs) and sectoral deployments in health, sustainability, and culture demonstrate Greece's commitment to leveraging AI for economic competitiveness and societal benefit.

Yet, persistent challenges remain. As outlined in recent ecosystem assessments and readiness indicators, Greece must accelerate the transfer of AI research into scalable, commercial applications, particularly among SMEs. Enhancing the usability of AI infrastructure, including compute resources like the DAEDALUS supercomputer and access to high-quality data, will be critical for enabling experimentation and reducing entry barriers. Talent shortages—especially in applied AI engineering and cross-disciplinary roles—further underscore the need to align educational pipelines and vocational training with market demand.

While Greece's governance model benefits from EU harmonization and strong regulatory foresight through the EU AI Act, domestic implementation must continue to ensure clarity, administrative simplicity, and effective enforcement. The enactment of Law 4961/2022 and designation of key authorities like the Hellenic Data Protection Authority and the Greek Ombudsman will be pivotal in shaping the operational landscape. Equally important will be the scaling of regulatory sandboxes and the institutionalization of participatory mechanisms—such as those supported by the AI Observatory and Co-ordinating Committee for AI—to maintain public trust in high-impact AI deployments.

To secure long-term leadership, Greece must double down on inclusive innovation strategies that bridge regional divides, empower SMEs and startups, and foster collaboration between academia, startups, and industry. Strategic international engagement—through its participation in EU initiatives, the OECD, and standardisation platforms—positions Greece to influence global AI norms and governance frameworks, particularly around safety, ethics, and sustainability. If Greece continues to act with strategic coherence, technical ambition, and a strong societal mandate, it can not only lead the European AI agenda—but also define the global trajectory for responsible, human-aligned AI systems. This acceleration will do well to translate national infrastructure, foresight, and regulatory creativity into accessible channels for local innovators. Practical support to SMEs, multidisciplinary AI training, and experiential models of adoption will be necessary to keep up with the pace and capture inclusive value.

The strategic groundwork is robust—the moment to accelerate execution is now.





Appendix A: Expert Views



Giannis Tolios

Freelance Data Scientist



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“The Greek market is currently shaped by innovative companies utilizing AI technologies. A dynamic interplay between academia, the private sector and government, will make Greece a key player in the era of artificial intelligence.”



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Biography

Giannis Tolios. As an experienced data scientist and researcher, Giannis is passionate about statistics, data visualization and machine learning. Giannis is also particularly interested in utilizing data science to mitigate climate change, and helping to accomplish the UN Sustainable Development Goals. This personal aspiration has been achieved by participating in research projects about climate change mitigation, such as DIAMOND and IAM-COMPACT. Giannis’ significant experience as a freelancer, has also given him the opportunity to collaborate with companies from all over the world, and acquire valuable experience, as well as a diverse skill set.





Christos Makris

Digital World Summit Greece



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"Greece's Pharos AI Factory and Daedalus supercomputer position the country as a strategic AI node, enabling testbeds and regulatory sandboxes that drive the development of trustworthy, human-centric AI under EU regulatory frameworks"



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Biography

Chris Makris is an Experienced freelance EU certified legal professional with 15+ years of court litigation, drafting privacy policies and assisting clients with GDPR compliance. Holds a Master's degree (LL.M.) in Law & Technology (Tilburg University) with a specialization in the Privacy and Security field, and also a Master's degree (LL.M.) in European & International Law (London Metropolitan University). Currently he acts as a Legal Policy Advisor for Digital World Summit Greece, the Greek initiative within the UN Internet Governance Forum network. He also participates as a Research Affiliate with Homo Digitalis' AI Working Group on the harmonization of the EU AI Act provisions into Greek legislation. His current activities focus on researching and drafting policies on the digital transformation and the harmonization of AI in the Greek territory.



**Yannis
Mastrogeorgiou**
*Government of the Hellenic
Republic*



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Greece is operationalising AI through the national strategy the Blueprint, uploaded on www.foresight.gov.gr. We are working on design authorities to enforce the AI Act, fund adoption via “Greece 2.0,” and deploy EuroHPC’s Daedalus and the Pharos AI Factory. Here are concrete, near-term AI deliverables for Greece: Launch of mAlgov on gov.gr—an AI assistant to route citizens to services and answer queries. Stand-up of the Pharos AI Factory (€30m, 36-month project) to give SMEs/startups datasets, training, compute and business support; operated by GRNET with Demokritos. Procurement and site build of EuroHPC “DAEDALUS” supercomputer (Lavrio) to power Pharos and national AI workloads. rollout underway. AI Act implementation steps: public list of national authorities for fundamental-rights oversight in high-risk AI



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Biography

Yannis Mastrogeorgiou is the Special Secretary for Strategic Foresight at the Presidency of the Government of the Hellenic Republic. He, was also the coordinator of the High Level Advisory Committee on Artificial Intelligence. Yannis has worked for years at the crossroads of politics, innovative policy research and communications. He served as Secretary General for Media and Communications in the Presidency of the Government, as Director of the Scientific Council with The Constantinos Caramanlis Institute for Democracy and as Executive Director with DIKTIO - Network for Reform in Greece and Europe, a leading Athens-based think tank, where he spearheaded informed Greek discourse on AI and its socioeconomic impact.





Prof. Dr. Fotios Fitsilis

Hellenic Parliament



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In the field of emerging technologies, Greece demonstrates both innovation and leadership. The Hellenic Parliament is the first legislature in the EU to align its digital transformation strategy with the development of the national AI infrastructure, i.e. Pharos, the AI Factory, which operates within the framework of the EuroHPC. This integration effectively translates interinstitutionality and interoperability policies into practice.



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Biography

Prof. Dr. Fotis Fitsilis is Head of the Department for Scientific Documentation and Supervision at the Hellenic Parliament's Scientific Service since 2009. With a multi-disciplinary background in electrical engineering, financial engineering, and international law, he has authored over 80 publications and seven books. In 2017, he co-founded the Hellenic OCR Team, a scientific crowdsourcing initiative for the processing and analysis of parliamentary data. Since 2025, he is Professor of AI and Parliamentary Governance at Universidad Austral, Buenos Aires.



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Stella Tsitsoula

RED Communications



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Artificial Intelligence can enhance education and skills development in Greece, equipping individuals with the digital, analytical, and creative skills needed in the modern economy. The government's decision to pilot AI integration into the school curriculum is a pivotal step in linking learning with innovation and entrepreneurship. For maximum impact, this strategy must include teacher training, equal access to infrastructure, open educational resources, and partnerships with universities and industry. Strong governance is also crucial, including risk assessments, data protection with privacy-by-design principles, age-appropriate security measures, algorithm transparency, and compliance with European frameworks (GDPR, AI Act). If implemented correctly, this approach can boost the digital ecosystem and long-term competitiveness, while safeguarding student rights and fostering social trust.



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Biography

Stella Tsitsoula is a communications consultant with 25+ years of experience in media, PR, and strategic communication, specializing in technology and cybersecurity. She is the Founder of RED.comm, Co-Founder of Women4Cyber Greece, and Communications Director of the National Cybersecurity Team, representing Greece in ENISA's Pan-European Cybersecurity Competition. She also serves on the Board of EDYTE-GRNET S.A., under the Ministry of Digital Governance, and is the Founder of the Hellenic Institute of Cybersecurity. A regular public speaker and advocate for diversity in tech, she was ranked #128 globally by LinkedIn (2025) among the Top 200 Women in Tech & Cybersecurity. Stella holds degrees in Computer Systems Engineering, Public Relations, an MBA, and is a certified ISO 9001:2015 Lead Auditor.





Georgios Petas

Senior Software Engineer



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The EU AI Act offers Greece both trust and opportunity, supporting responsible AI adoption by startups and SMEs while highlighting the need to balance regulation with entrepreneurial agility.



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Biography

Georgios Petas is a Microsoft MVP in Developer Technologies and Senior Software Engineer with extensive experience across the financial and marketing technology sectors. He has led the design and development of core banking systems, including credit, loan, and billing platforms, and more recently contributing to the growth of an email marketing platform supporting international expansion. His career reflects both technical expertise and leadership, having guided engineering teams, mentored colleagues, and driven large-scale system transformations. Georgios holds a BSc in Computer Software Engineering from the University of West Attica, complemented by studies in Computer Science at Linnaeus University in Sweden. As a tech content creator, he is committed to sharing programming insights, fostering professional growth, and contributing to Greece's evolving technology and AI ecosystem..



Appendix B: From Brain Drain to Brain Gain: Greece's AI Talent Challenge



Ester Martinez

Investor & Advisor



Ester Martinez is a dynamic founder and CEO with of experience scaling a B2B media and community brand across India and Southeast Asia. Proven record in building businesses from the ground up, leading cross-border teams, raising capital, succession planning and founder transition. Now based in Athens and advising scale-ups & venture-backed companies on brand, GTM, culture, compensation, and leadership.

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/estermartinez/>

As someone relatively new to the Greek startup scene, I've been surprised by what I've discovered. The government talks about AI transformation—standard political language—but the underlying fundamentals caught my attention. Greece's tech sector grew 15% in 2024, and Greek AI startups pulled in €123 million in funding, ranking second in Central and Eastern Europe. These aren't vanity metrics. In my experience, capital follows opportunity, and investors don't write checks based on government promises alone. Further, Greece has the data advantage. The country has decades of public sector information across healthcare, maritime, tourism, and energy—exactly the kind of structured datasets that AI companies need to build meaningful applications.

While realizing these AI ambitions requires addressing fundamental challenges in infrastructure and data modernization, the biggest challenge will be talent retention. That requires careful consideration. The talent story is where Greece gets really interesting. The University of Athens claims 11% of the world's leading AI researchers are Greek—a bold statement with no methodology behind it. However, other manifestations of this talent concentration are clearly visible: the Greeks in AI Symposium 2025 featured keynote speakers from MIT, Stanford, Carnegie Mellon, and Google; major tech companies



like Google have established AI training partnerships with Greek universities; and Greece was selected to host one of only seven EU AI Factories. Greek researchers are publishing in top conferences. For a country of 10 million people, that's disproportionate representation. Whether it's 11% or 5% of global AI talent doesn't matter—what matters is that Greece is punching well above its weight, and smart institutions are taking notice.

This talent concentration creates both opportunities and challenges. The opportunity lies in the potential for reverse brain drain, where Greek AI professionals working in Silicon Valley, London, and other global hubs might be attracted to return home by the prospect of contributing to the country's technological transformation—supported by world-class computational infrastructure that provides the research environment these professionals need. The real challenge is obvious to anyone who's worked abroad: how do you compete with Silicon Valley salaries and Global opportunities? Greece has the talent, but keeping it is another story. The government talks about "initiatives to create attractive conditions"—that's usual. What we need are practical moves: competitive research funding, tax incentives, and partnerships that actually move the needle. The test is in whether a Greek AI researcher at Stanford has compelling reasons to come home.

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The opportunity here is real. Greece has built solid computational infrastructure and sits on valuable datasets—the kind of foundation that takes years to develop. But infrastructure without talent is just hardware & software. The question isn't whether Greece can become an AI hub—it's whether they can move fast enough to keep their best people home and attract others before the window closes. In my experience, these moments don't last forever.



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Appendix C: Empowering The Next Wave of Human Evolution: Augmented Intelligence



Dr. Yiannis Kalogerakis

CEO, JMK



Dr. Yiannis Kalogerakis is a Culture Architect, CEO of JMK, and President of IUPT. An international keynote speaker and 8-time TEDx speaker, he holds a PhD in Robotics from Strathclyde University in Scotland and brings 43 years of experience training executives across five continents to advance their careers, leadership, and ethical effectiveness. His recent focus is on Anthropocentric Ethical AI, placing humans, not machines, at the center of technological progress.

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/jmkgr/>

AI does not replace humans, nor simply help them do things faster. When guided by ethics and an anthropocentric approach, AI makes humans SUPERHUMANS, able to learn, unlearn, relearn, and repeat in ways never before possible, while empowering them to become infinitely more creative and extraordinary strategic thinkers.

Analysis

Greece's AI ecosystem is still at an early stage compared to larger EU states, but it offers a unique opportunity: to ground innovation in Anthropocentric Ethical AI. This is more than a policy choice, it is a cultural heritage, drawing on Greece's philosophical tradition of placing the human at the center of knowledge.



The Greek approach moves beyond viewing AI as a productivity tool. It positions AI as a transformative partner, expanding not only intelligence and creativity but also the strategic, ethical, and emotional capacity of human beings. In this light, AI is not a substitute for humans, it is the next wave of human augmentation, enabling individuals and societies to reach unprecedented levels of wisdom and foresight.

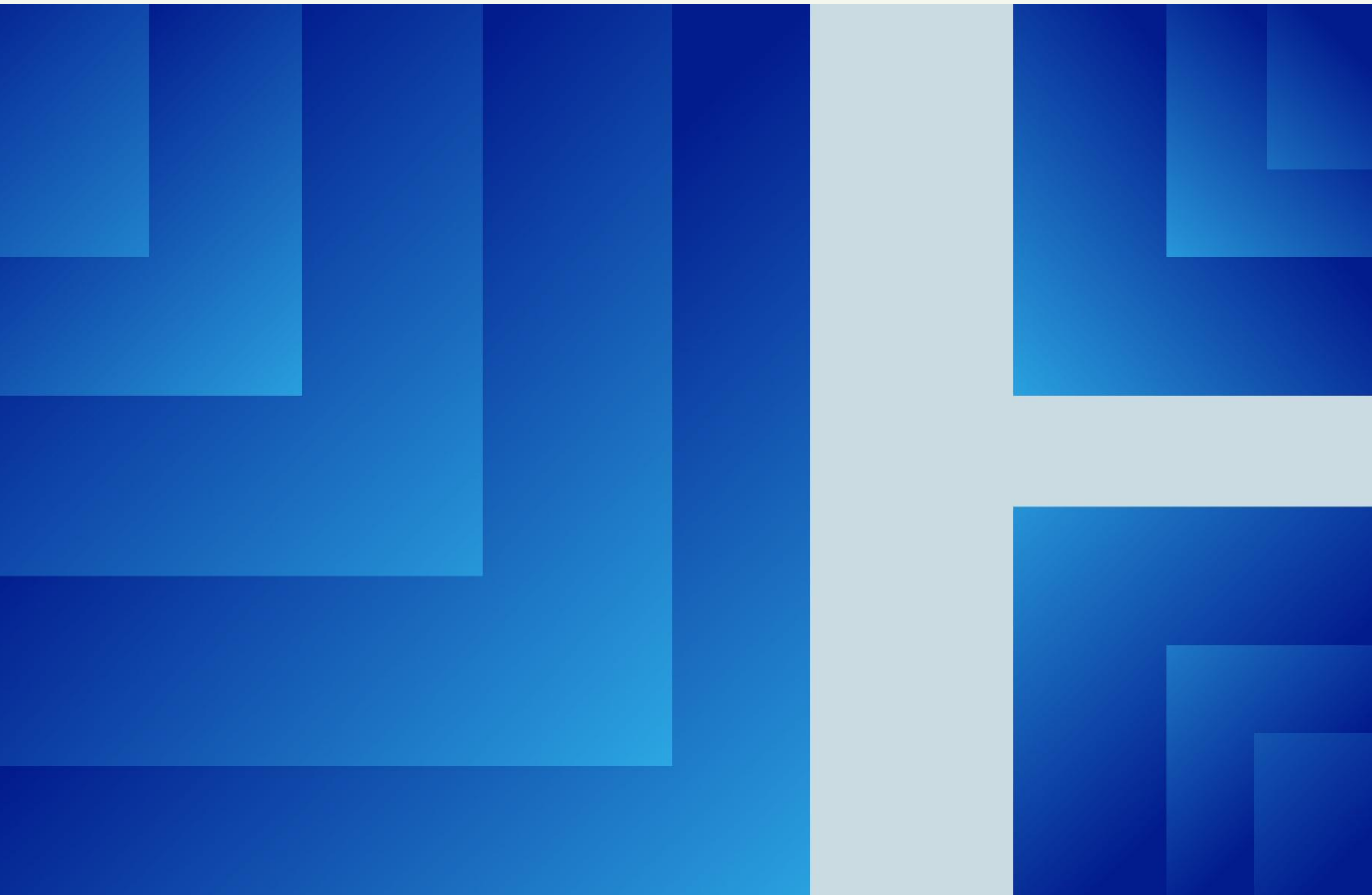
According to the Oxford Insights Government AI Readiness Index, Greece still ranks below the EU average. Yet this “gap” can be an advantage: Greece can pivot faster, with agility, education, and responsible leadership, avoiding the bureaucratic inertia of larger states. By fostering collaboration among universities, research centers, and enterprises, Greece could become a European hub for ethical AI experimentation.

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With alignment to the EU AI Act and a cultural legacy that champions philosophy, democracy, and ethics, Greece is well-positioned not only to adopt AI but to influence the global narrative of AI ethics. By exporting ideas, training frameworks, and human-centric methodologies, Greece can define the role of AI as a force that serves humanity, empowering people to become super-creative, super-strategic, and deeply ethical leaders of the future.



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Appendix D: OECD Insights on Governing with Artificial Intelligence in Greece



Stella Tsitsoula

RED Communications



The OECD's 2024 report "Governing with Artificial Intelligence" provides additional context for Greece's AI governance trajectory, complementing the national perspectives already outlined. These insights highlight areas where Greece aligns with, and can further leverage, international best practices.

1. Governance and Institutional Capacity

The OECD stresses the importance of whole-of-government approaches and strong institutional coordination in AI governance. Greece's establishment of bodies such as the High-Level Advisory Committee on AI and the AI Observatory is consistent with this recommendation. However, the OECD also underlines the need for regulatory agility and cross-ministerial integration. For Greece, this means ensuring that AI oversight does not remain siloed within the Ministry of Digital Governance but is embedded across education, health, labor, and justice ministries to address cross-cutting risks.

2. Strategic Use of Data and Infrastructure

According to the OECD, trusted data ecosystems and compute infrastructure are essential for enabling responsible AI. Greece's Pharos AI Factory and DAEDALUS supercomputer are concrete steps in this direction. To align with OECD guidance, Greece should prioritize not only technical capacity but also fair access for SMEs and civil society. Ensuring equitable participation will help prevent concentration of AI capabilities in a handful of institutions or large enterprises.



3. Human Capital and Skills

The OECD highlights AI skills development as a cornerstone of responsible governance. Greece has begun integrating AI into its school curriculum and expanding training programs for civil servants. The OECD framework suggests going further by embedding lifelong learning mechanisms, multidisciplinary training, and targeted reskilling programs for sectors most at risk of automation. Particular attention should be given to fostering diversity in AI careers, ensuring gender balance, and empowering regions outside Athens and Thessaloniki.

4. Innovation and Risk Management

OECD findings emphasize the balance between innovation-friendly experimentation and risk-based regulation. Greece's use of AI Testing and Experimentation Facilities (TEFs) and planned regulatory sandboxes aligns closely with this best practice. The OECD encourages governments to scale such mechanisms beyond pilots and ensure that lessons learned feed directly into regulatory updates. For Greece, institutionalizing this feedback loop would strengthen adaptive governance and accelerate the safe deployment of AI in critical sectors like health, energy, and shipping.

5. International Cooperation and Standards

The OECD underscores the value of international cooperation and alignment with global standards. Greece already participates in EU-level initiatives and has endorsed UNESCO and OECD AI principles. Looking ahead, Greece can strengthen its role as a regional hub for ethical AI governance by actively sharing its experiences—particularly on balancing democratic values with digital innovation—within OECD, UNESCO, and EU platforms.





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